UNIT 5: WHAT'S NEXT

TOPIC 5: LONG-TERM GOAL SETTING

Topic OBJECTIVE: The learner will:

- Understand and identify long-term goals

Topic OUTCOME: The learner will:

- Create a written plan for long-term goals for their Student Career Portfolio

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objective: Students will understand the meaning of "motivation" along with identifying some of the "hurdles" that can get in the way of achieving goals.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Be Motivated,"** pens/pencils

Ask students to discuss their thoughts on the definition of the word "motivation" (to provide one with the feeling/urge to complete a task or achieve a goal). Ask students to identify what motivates them (could be money, sense of belonging, sense of fun, feeling of responsibility, praise, self-satisfaction, attention, etc.). Ask students what "hurdles" can take away from those motivators (lack of self-confidence, illness, lack of sleep, anger, etc.). Hand out the **"Be Motivated"** handout, and go through the scenarios as a class. Afterwards, ask students to answer questions about their own hurdles privately on their handout.

Writing/Reflection/Assessment

Objective: Students will refer to their previous assessments and assignments to make connections between, and conclusions about, their attributes that can help them identify their long-terms goals.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Envisioning My Future,"** pens/pencils

Envisioning My Future — Hand out the **"Envisioning My Future"** handout and ask students to do a brief guided imagery, where they picture themselves in a satisfying career. Ask them to picture the setting, their clothes, what they are doing, etc. Explain that it is important for them to picture themselves achieving their goals, along with believing they can achieve their goals. Ask, students to complete the handout, using their previous assessments to fill in the blanks. This will give the students an opportunity to see patterns and connections that may help them focus on long-term goals.

My Life Plan

Objective: The students will create a written life plan that focuses on their education and career goals.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handouts: **"My Life Plan, Parts 1 and 2,"** pens/pencils

Using the education, financial, and career information the students have gathered and learned in the previous lessons, ask the students to fill out **"My Life Plan, Parts 1 and 2"** handouts. Explain that **Part 1** will help them to keep their education, credits, and test scores in one place (they can estimate and/or fill in any information they do not have at a later date). Describe that **Part 2** is a **"Long-Term Goal Sheet"** with smaller goals that can serve as steps towards their long-term goals. A final version of both handouts should go into their Student Career Portfolio.

Be Motivated

Anyone who has ever made a New Year's resolution on January 1 and broken it by January 10, knows that setting goals doesn't guarantee that you'll reach them. Why? A big reason is *disappearing motivation.*

"Just do it!" Sounds so easy, but everyone knows getting and staying motivated is often the hardest part of doing anything.

Motivation is connected to goals, values, wants, wishes and how you can make them happen. Getting motivated to do something can be like running an obstacles course. Why is this true? Each of us has his or her own *hurdles*. They might include: *self-confidence, people who don't believe in us, procrastination, learning difficulties,* or *illness*. These hurdles can make us give up even before we start, or quit trying before we reach our goal. What are your motivation hurdles? Do you use effective strategies to "jump" them?

Read on to get more ideas about hurdles and "jumping."

A Case of Low Self Confidence

People tell Gary he's a nerd. He is 13 and spends hours every day on his computer. Any math or science problem, Gary can figure it out somehow. Everyone assumes he'll graduate and do something that involves computers, but he wants to be a test pilot and fly for the Air Force. He hasn't talked with his friends, family or counselor about this goal. He thinks he'd have to pass difficult physical and mental tests and Gary says he has low self-esteem.

List Gary's motivation hurdles

Look back on the resiliency skills — what do you think are Gary's strong and weak areas?

Confidence is the most important ingredient in motivation; think, "I can make this happen." Without it, a plan is dead in the water. But confidence must be built from inside. You have to push yourself to where you're doing things you didn't think you could do. Or even doing things you don't want to do — yes, like homework, or going to the library to get accurate information about a topic. Stretch yourself, believe in yourself.

A Case of Not Now

Stephanie waits until the last minute to do anything. She's a high school junior, and used to be a very good student, but her habit of procrastination, putting things off, has hurt her. Last semester she handed in her book reviews late or not at all and was docked two grades. She may fail English. She wants to go to college to study business so she can be an entrepreneur. She'll need a scholarship. People tell her to manage her time better. Some tell her she's just lazy.

List Stephanie's hurdles and resiliency strengths and weaknesses

Procrastination is one of the most common motivation hurdles. Many people make the mistake of thinking procrastination is just a problem of managing time. Or they think procrastinators are lazy.

The reasons people procrastinate are often complex and emotional. Often, procrastinators aren't consciously aware of why they put off things, or "work best under last minute pressure." Many fear failure. They imagine the consequences of doing something badly, or less than perfectly, are so horrible that they avoid doing it as long as possible. People worry that if they do something wrong they'll be laughed at, criticized, embarrassed, or demeaned.

A Case of "I Give Up"

Levin is 15 and has always been a slow learner. His parents didn't graduate from high school and say, "slow learners run in our family." When Levin reads he mixes up letters, when he writes he can't spell words correctly, in math he hates fractions. He says, "I don't try any more. I finish a test as fast as possible, even if I don't get the right answers." He wants to learn more about using computers, but he knows that won't happen.

List Levin's motivation hurdles and resiliency strengths/weaknesses.

Levin was lucky this school year. His teacher wouldn't let him give up. She taught him how to try harder and smarter. He tried new study habits, such as breaking down assignments into smaller pieces and completing each piece before he went on to the next. He asked for help when he needed it, but always finished the easy examples first so he could show what he did know, not just what he didn't. He went to the library and got books on tape so he could "read" in depth and use the computers — his teacher told him, "Just because it takes you time to improve your academic skills, doesn't mean you can't learn or that you're dumb. Get out there and make things happen." She believed he could learn and set and accomplish goals, and he did.

Levin found a mentor, someone to guide and believe in him, but also to say, "hey, focus your energy on what you can do not what you can't." Experiencing frustration, failure and the negative thinking of others makes many people give up. Often people mistakenly think that a failure shows they're stupid. They conclude that there's nothing they can do in the future. So they evade and avoid similar situations.

People who are motivated analyze the situation and understand the need to master skills they don't currently have. Take chances. Failure can tell you what you're able to do now — not what you're able to learn or do in the future.

A Case of What Will They Think?

Bill's friend got him a job working with him on an assembly line. Bill is new, but very quick. His boss has commented on his excellent work. Bill's friend says Bill should stop showing off, he doesn't like it and neither do the other workers.

Bill's motivation hurdles?

Friends can be a motivation hurdle. They can hold you back. People stay or become unmotivated because they fear losing friends. It takes a lot of courage to stand up to friends or to give them up. But friends can help you achieve your goals. True friends want the best for you.

Think About IT

List two of your own motivation hurdles.

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

Be Motivated

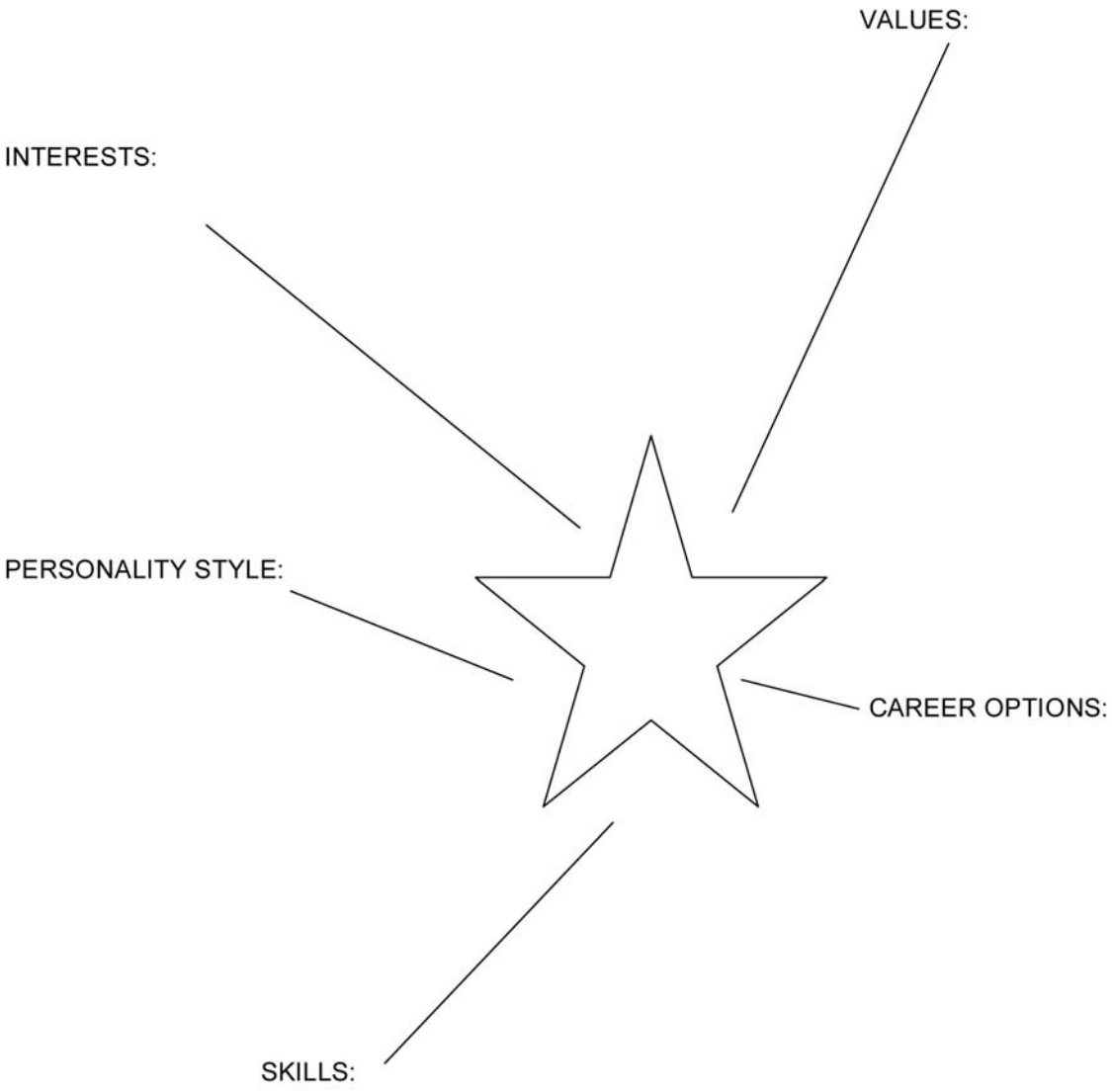
Close your eyes. Picture yourself in a career. You are happy working in this occupation. You are envisioning your future.

You have gathered information about yourself and the world of work. Wouldn't it be helpful if you could put all this information together and see what conclusions you can draw about yourself? This activity is a way to do this.

Look at the work you have saved in your portfolio. You will use this to make your *Self-Awareness Profile*. This profile is a current "snap shot" of all your preferences. How will it help you to see future possibilities?

Directions:

1. You can see there are 5 main branches coming from the center, **Personality Style, Values, Interests, Career Options, Skills.** Under each main branch ago the details. What are 3 details about the main branch **"Interests"?** What picture or drawings could show these interests?
2. Use the *Self-Awareness Profile* or draw it yourself. Add details to each main branch. Use pictures and words.
3. Look at all the information on your paper. Do you see some patterns? Do you see connections between your skills and interests, for example? **If you do, draw arrows to show the connections. If you don't ask your instructor to help you.**



Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

My Life Plan (Part 1)

Student: _____ Age: _____ Date: _____

If my present academic level in reading_____, math_____, and language_____(test scores from TABE, WOJO, New Century, or other), and my career aspirations are_____ (based on recent assessment or work experience), what education and/or training do I need to achieve my career goal?

Continuum of Education

- ☐ 8th grade diploma/literacy — (anticipated or completion date:_____)
- ☐ High School Diploma — (current number of credits:_____, number required:_____, anticipated or completion date:_____)
- ☐ GED — (anticipated or completion date:_____)
- ☐ Vocational/Trade School — (area/subject:_____; cost $_____; anticipated or completion date:_____)
- ☐ Community College (2 year) — (area/subject:_____; cost $_____; anticipated or completion date:_____)
- ☐ University (4 year) — (area/subject:_____; cost $_____; anticipated or completion date:_____)

What barriers or challenges exist? How will I overcome them?

_____

_____

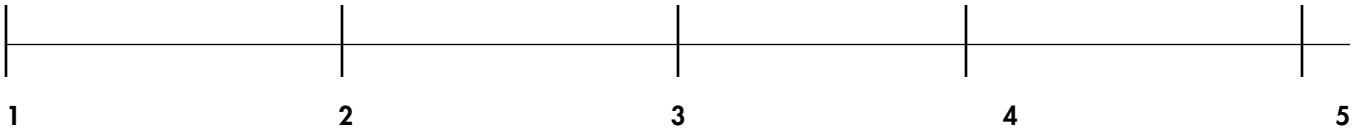
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Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003

My Life Plan (Part 2)

My 5-Year Career Plan Time Line



1 **2** **3** **4** **5**

My Life Plan (Future Vision)

Age 8 **14** **18** **21** **30** **40** **50** **60 < beyond (Retirement)**

Planning ideas:

Financial: _____

Community: _____

Leisure: _____

Relationships: _____

Career/Learning: _____

Family: _____

Spiritual: _____

Health/Wellness: _____

Other: _____

Thoughts and reflections:

_____

_____

_____

_____

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003